Imperator Black — Quick Reference rules v0.5

The round

• **Initiative:** each side 2d6 + the Nerve of its Leader with the highest Nerve. Winner chooses who activates first. Reroll ties.
• **Activations:** alternate one model at a time; two actions each. When one side runs out, the other finishes.
• **End of round:** (1) Bleeding/Critical clocks; (2) Down models test 8+ to recover; (3) unhit models in cover lose 1 Suppression; (4) hazards; (5) mission effects; (6) clear Activated (Overwatch stays).

Attributes

Attr.	Used for
MOV	Inches per Move action (usually 5-7). Training, exoskeletons and heavy kit all show here.
SHT	Hit rolls, Suppressive Fire and reaction shots.
FGT	Close combat exchanges.
PHY	Throwing, forcing doors with a breaching tool, holding on in decompression, getting up when Down.
NRV	Breaking tests, Find Cover, and initiative for Leaders.
TEC	Medic actions, hacking, putting out fires and other technical work.
W	Wounded markers a model can carry; one more puts it Down.
SZ	Physical bulk: 1 small drone, 2 human, 3 large (walkers and vehicles are larger). Used by rules for hatches, cover and vehicles.

A test is 2d6 + the named attribute, −1 per Suppression, −1 if Wounded; 8+ unless stated. Rank is a label only.

Actions

Action	Effect
Move	Up to Move. Obstacle +2". Contact with an enemy starts close combat.
Shoot	Hit roll vs a visible target.
Aim	+1 to the next Shoot this activation.
Suppressive Fire	Auto only. Hit: +1 Suppression (+2 if beating 8 by 3+). No damage.
Throw	Grenade; 2d6 + Physique, 8+ to land on the point. Handy.
Overwatch	Last action. Up to two reactions before this model next activates.
Find Cover	In the open within 1" of micro-terrain: 2d6 + Nerve, 7+ Light, 10+ Heavy.
Rally	Remove 1 Suppression from self or a friend within 6" (2 with a Leader).
Medic	Treat a Down/Bleeding/Critical friend in contact.
Interact	Objective, door, console or charge within 1".

Reactions

• **Who:** a model not yet activated (it becomes Activated), or a model on Overwatch (up to two).
• **Triggers (in its line of sight):** enemy Moves (interrupt anywhere along the move); Shoots, Throws, Suppressive Fire or Interacts (after); comes into view of an Overwatch model for any reason (at once).
• **Door opens:** (1) resolve the opening; (2) cracked-in grenade lands; (3) far side reacts; (4) opening side's Overwatch reacts; (5) opener carries on. Once per model per door.
• **One action:** Shoot the trigger at −1; Move up to half to cover or out of sight; or Find Cover.
• **Timing:** never simultaneous. The trigger resolves in full first (damage, Suppression, casualty shock); then only models still able may react. Down: no reaction; Pinned: Find Cover only.
• No reactions to reactions. Pinned: Find Cover only. 2+ Suppression removes Overwatch. Cumbersome can't react.

Shooting

• Throw 2d6 hit dice **with** the damage dice. Hit: 2d6 + **Shoot** + modifiers ≥ **8**. Natural 2 misses; double 6 is a critical (+1 row).
• Damage total → wound row, +1 if critical, then step down by Armour − AP. Row ≤ 0: no effect.
• Range: beyond short −1, beyond double −2 (shotgun −2/−3). No maximum range.
• Cover: Light ≥⅓ hidden or a model in the way; Heavy ≥½ hidden behind solid material.

Hit modifier	Value
Aim	+1
Target in Light cover	-1
Target in Heavy cover	-2
Each Suppression on shooter	-1
Shooter has any Wounded markers	-1
Moved earlier this activation (not Handy)	-1
Reaction or Overwatch shot	-1
Unbraced in zero-g (not Void-trained)	-1
Target in darkness beyond 6" (no low-light gear)	-2

Wound table

Row	Total	Result
1	2–3	Shaken: +1 Suppression
2	4–4	Rattled: +2 Suppression
3	5–5	Grazed: +1 Suppression
4	6–7	Wounded: add a Wounded marker. More markers than Wounds: Down
5	8–9	Wounded and +1 Suppression. More markers than Wounds: Down
6	10–11	Down: may recover (end-of-round test 8+, or Medic)
7	12–13	Down and bleeding: dies at end of third round unless Medic 8+
8	14–15	Critical: dies at end of next round unless Medic 10+
9	16–18	Dead
10	19+	Dead; friends within 1" gain 1 Suppression

Rows above 10 count as 10. Wounded = −1 to all rolls.

Weapon and armour keywords

Keyword	Effect
Handy	Ignores the moved-this-activation penalty.
Auto	Auto N: may use Suppressive Fire. Shoot or Suppressive Fire may engage up to N models within 3" of the first target, one roll each, -1 after the first.
Suppressing	A hit also adds 1 Suppression.
One per round	May fire once per round, including reactions.
Cumbersome	An extra -1 when firing after a Move; cannot fire as a reaction.
Blast	Affects every model within the blast radius with line of sight to the point of impact.
Confined	+1 wound row to models in an enclosed compartment of 6" x 6" or smaller.
Breach	Can destroy doors, hatches and thin bulkheads.
Silenced	Shots do not count as noise for the alert track.
Sealed	Protected from vacuum and smoke; resists decompression tests (+2).
Heavy	Bulky armour. Its weight is already reflected in the wearer's Move.
Suppressive Fire (action)	Auto weapons only. Hit roll, no damage: +1 Suppression, or +2 if the roll beats 8 by 3+.

Imperator Black — Quick Reference (2)

Weapons

Weapon	Dmg	Short	AP	Keywords
Sidearm	2d6	8"	0	Handy
SMG	2d8	12"	0	Handy, Auto 2
Carbine	2d8	18"	0	Handy
Shotgun	2d12	10"	0	Handy
Rifle	2d8	30"	0	—
Heavy rifle	2d8	30"	1	—
LMG	2d8	30"	0	Auto 3, Suppressing
Compact LMG	2d8	18"	0	Handy, Auto 3, Suppressing
DMR	2d10	48"	0	—
AT launcher	2d12	36"	1	One per round, Cumbersome

Melee	Dmg	AP
Unarmed / weapon butt	2d4	0
Knife or bayonet	2d8	0
Breaching tool or heavy blade	2d10	0

Armour	Value	Keywords
None	0	—
Flak	1	—
Void suit	1	Sealed
Composite plate	2	—
Void plate	2	Sealed
Heavy plate	3	Sealed, Heavy

Close combat

• Starts when a model Moves into contact (a Move: it can trigger reactions). Resolves at once, in exchanges.
• Each exchange: both roll 2d6 + **Fight**. Charge +1 (first exchange); +1 per friend also touching the enemy (max +2); −1 per Suppression; −1 if Wounded.
• Higher wins and rolls its melee damage on the wound table. Tie: both +1 Suppression. No effect: loser still +1 Suppression.
• A model at 5 Suppression that loses is overpowered: Down, or captured if allowed.
• After each exchange the loser, then the winner, declares Continue or Break. It ends only when both break (each moves 1" apart).

Tokens (cube colours)

Token	Cube	Use
Activated	Blue	Activated or reacted unactivated this round. Clear at end of round.
Overwatch	Green	Two when placed; remove one per reaction.
Suppression	Yellow	One per point, max 5.
Wounded	Red	One per Wounded marker.
Down	—	Lay the model on its side.
Bleeding / Critical	Black	On a Down model: 3 / 1 rounds left. Remove one each later round end; last removed: dies.
Locked door	Black	On the door.
Hack progress	Red / White	On the door: red per failed attempt (+1 each, max 3), white per success.
Last-known position	White	The enemy marker. Also marks a surrendered model.

Alerted enemy element: turn its unit cards sideways.

Grenades and breaching

• Throw up to double range: test 2d6 + **Physique** (−1 beyond range), 8+ lands on target. Miss: lands short by the miss (min 1"). Natural 2: lands 2" in front of the thrower. Zero-g: bounces past instead.
• Frag: one damage roll for all; step down per model's Armour; Heavy cover −1 row; same compartment ≤ 6"×6": +1 row.
• Breaching charge: place (Interact), detonate later (action). Door destroyed; within 1": 2d6; far side within 2": +2 Suppression, no reactions this round.
• **Crack and throw:** within 1" of a closed, unlocked door: open it and Throw in one Interact, before anyone reacts. Miss: lands in the doorway.
• Locked door: charge; breaching tool (Interact, test 8+); or hack (Interact, 2d6 + Tech, quiet): Basic 7+; Secured 9+; Hardened 9+ ×2; Military 10+ ×2. +1 per earlier failed attempt on it (max +3).

Grenade	Range	Radius	Effect
Frag grenade	8"	2"	2d8 damage
Flashbang	8"	3"	+2 Suppression; removes Overwatch; cannot react until end of round
Smoke grenade	8"	2"	Blocks line of sight through the area until end of next round

Suppression, morale, casualties

• Suppression: −1 to all rolls each (max 5). **Pinned at 3+**: only Rally, Find Cover, Move to cover/out of sight, Shoot from cover.
• Casualty shock: friend within 6" goes Down or Dead: +1 Suppression (+2 if the Leader).
• Breaking: half a fireteam out → each tests 2d6 + **Nerve** (+1 Leader within 6") at activation; fail = both actions moving away.
• Wounded markers from rows 4–5; any marker −1 to all rolls; more markers than Wounds → Down. Down: end of round 2d6 + **Physique** 8+ to rise (3 Suppression, markers = Wounds). Medic action, 2d6 + **Tech**: Down 8+ (auto with Medic), Bleeding 8+ (becomes Down), Critical 10+ (stabilised).

Ship hazards

• **Zero-g:** push off in a straight line; end on a surface or keep drifting. Unbraced −1 to shoot, throw and fight (not Void-trained).
• **Decompression:** each model tests 2d6 + Physique, 8+ (+2 Sealed), or is dragged d6" to the breach; doors seal at end of round; vacuum follows.
• **Vacuum:** unsealed models ending an activation there go Critical. Shooting is silent. No fire or smoke.
• **Fire:** 2d6 damage on entering or ending there (Sealed +1 armour); spreads on 10+, out on 2–3; extinguish 2d6 + Tech, 8+.
• **Darkness:** seen only within 12"; −2 beyond 6" unless Low-light; a model that shot this round is seen at −1.